

Appendix 4

Definition of Finished Leather

Appendix – 4

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Public Notice No. 15 /2015-2020 dated 04th September 2020.

Subject: Export of Finished Leather- Revised Leather Norms

In exercise of the powers conferred by Section 5 of the Foreign Trade (Development & Regulation) Act, 1992 (No 22 of 1992) read with Para 2.04 of the Foreign Trade Policy 2015-20 , the Director General of Foreign Trade hereby specifies, for the purpose of the entry “Finished Leather all kinds” appearing at *Serial No: 176, Chapter 41, Schedule 2 – Export Policy, of the Foreign Trade Policy 2015-20*, that the items mentioned in column 2 of the table hereunder shall constitute “Finished Leather” and the same may be exported without a license but subject to the terms and conditions specified against each item in column 3 of the table hereunder.”

S. No.	Description of item	Manufacturing Norms Conditions.
1.	2.	3.
I	Leathers with finishing coat (All substrates – Goat and Sheep skins and Bovine hides/sides calf skins including splits)	a. Tanning b. Dyeing(optional) c. Fatliquoring d. Finishing coat
II	Suede Leathers (All substrates including splits)	a. Tanning b. Dyeing in light/pastel/medium/dark shades (in case of doubt, the presence of dye to be ascertained by chromatographic technique or spectrophotometric technique) c. Fatliquoring d. Buffing to produce suede nap e. Shaving/snuffing of the grain along the backbone 2 inches on either side in the case of goat and sheep skins and in the case of bovine hides/sides and calf skins all over the grain side
III	Nubuck Leathers (All substrates including butts and bends)	a. Tanning b. Dyeing in light/pastel/medium/dark shades (in case of doubt, the presence of dye to be ascertained by chromatographic technique or spectrophotometric technique) c. Fatliquoring

Appendix – 4

Definition of Finished Leather

		d. Buffing on the grain to produce nap with writing effect (or) Buffing on the grain and presence of oil in the case of oil nubuck leather(or) Buffing on the grain and presence of wax in the case of waxy nubuck leather.
IV	Bovine hides/sides based Lining Leathers, Goat and Sheep based Lining Leathers	Thickness upto 1.0 mm for Bovine lining leathers and 0.8 mm for Goat & Sheep lining leathers. a. Tanning b. Dyeing in light/pastel/medium/dark shades (in the case of doubt, the presence of dye to be ascertained by chromatographic technique or spectrophotometric technique) c. Fatliquoring
V	Gloving leathers (All substrates):	Thickness should be less than or equal to 1.0 mm . Run should be minimum of 15% in the case of wax coat. In case wax coat is absent, run shall not be lesser than 25%. a. Tanning b. Dyeing (optional) c. Fatliquoring d. Wax coat (optional)
VI	Burnishable Leathers (All substrates including butts and bends)	a. Tanning b. Dyeing in light/pastel/medium/dark shades (in case of doubt, the presence of dye to be ascertained by chromatographic technique or spectrophotometric technique) c. Fatliquoring d. Wax coat e. Burnishable effect on rubbing (Minimum CIEΔL value of -3.0 on 10 dry rubbing on SATRA Fastness tester or any other fastness tester as measured on a Reflectance spectrophotometer)

Appendix – 4

Definition of Finished Leather

VII	Pull Up Leather – Wax/Oil (All substrates including butts and bends)	a. Tanning b. Dyeing in light/pastel/medium/dark shades(in case of doubt, the presence of dye to be ascertained by chromatographic technique or spectrophotometric technique) c. Fatliquoring d. Wax coat (or) Oilcoat e. Pull up effect (Minimum CIE ΔL value of +3.0 as measured on a reflectance spectrophotometer)
VIII	Heavy Leathers including sole leather, harness and belting leathers (Bovine hides/sides including butts and bends)	Heavy substance with thickness of 3.0 mm or more and with minimum of apparent density 0.9 gm/cc) a. Tanning b. Oiling/stuffing c. Rolling /Plating
IX	Hair/wool on leathers (All substrates including rabbit skins)	a. Tanning b. Dyeing(optional) c. Fatliquoring d. Wool/hair combing
X	Laminated Leathers (All substrates including splits)	a. Tanning b. Dyeing(optional) c. Fatliquoring d. Application of foil/film/lamination on grain or flesh side of the leathers.
XI	Chamois Leathers (All substrates)	a. Aldehyde and oil combination tanning b. Buffing to produce suede nap c. Complete shaving/snuffing of the grain
XII	Shrunken Grain/Washed leathers (All substrates).	a. Tanning b. Dyeing (in the case of doubt, the presence of dye to be ascertained by chromatographic or spectrophotometric technique) c. Fatliquoring

Appendix – 4

Definition of Finished Leather

		d. Wax coat(or) oil coat. Should have pronounced change in the grain pattern/texture of grain
XIII	Wax/Oil coated leathers	a. Tanning b. Dyeing (in the case of doubt, the presence of dye to be ascertained by chromatographic or spectrophotometric technique) c. Fatliquoring d. Wax coat (or) Oil Coat
XIV	3D Effect, Embossed leathers, Scaling, Perforated leathers etc;	a. Tanning b. Dyeing (optional) c. Fatliquoring d. Effect should be uniform, pronounced and shall be seen throughout the leather grain or flesh surface.

NOTE: Any new type of finished leather not covered under the above categories shall be permitted for export, subject to testing and certification by Central Leather Research Institute (CLRI).

DEFINITIONS OF MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS

Tanning -Tanning with one or more than one kind of tanning agent, such as mineral tanning and vegetable tanning and / or syntan tanning and/ or resin tanning and/or aldehyde tanning, oil tanning in any sequence and or any new type of tanning.

Dyeing – Treating the leather with a solution of dye/s to impart a color. In case of doubt the presence of dye should be ascertained by extracting dye from leather using suitable solvent mixture and by running thin layer chromatography (TLC).

NOTE: 1: - Testing for the presence of dye:

By Chromatographic technique:

Organic layer separated from Butanol, acetic acid and water mixture taken in the ratio 4: 1: 5, using a separating funnel is taken as the eluting solvent for TLC analysis. Dye is extracted from the leather

Appendix – 4

Definition of Finished Leather

using dichloromethane and methanol (1: 1) mixture. The cut pieces of leather are heated in a water bath with the solvent mixture for few minutes. The extracted dye is kept as a spot on the TLC paper and the strip is kept in the eluting solvent such that the dye spot lies above the solvent level. The presence of the dye is confirmed by its movement to a considerable distance and from the formation of a dye curve or peak on the TLC paper.

By Spectrophotometric technique:

Known sample of leather is taken for dye extraction by suitable solvent mixture. Extracted solution is filtered and then 2 ml of the same is taken in cuvette and run through the UV Visible Spectrophotometer. Sample is run for set conditions of equipment and presence of dye spectrum is noted in visible region of wavelength (400 to 800 nm) to confirm the presence of dye in leather sample.

Fat liquoring – Treating the leather with oil and/or fat, emulsified in water for rendering the leather soft.

Finishing Coat – Finishing coat shall contain a film forming material/ binder in combination with colorants such as pigments or dyes or a combination of both. The film forming material/binder shall comprise materials singly or in combination such as proteins or synthetic acrylic or polyurethane, vinyl lacquers or lacquer emulsions. If necessary, microscopic examination of the surface at minimum 100 times magnification shall be carried out to detect the finishing coat.

NOTE 2: - Microscopic examination for finish coat:

Binocular stereoscopic microscope with (two paired) objectives capable of viewing the objects at a total magnification of 100X will be required. Stereoscopic microscope gives a three-dimensional view of the object.

Leather sample to be examined is placed on the stage of the microscope with the grain facing the objectives and then the surface is focused. Two or three places in each of the five locations namely butt, belly (one each side of the backbone line) and neck or shoulder examined.

To the naked eye, the grain surface may appear to be plain, but when focused under microscope, innumerable depressions can be seen on the surface. These depressions are due to cleavages lines and hair pores. If the finish coat is sprayed on the grain surface, it will be present throughout, including depressed areas and both the depressed and other areas will produce the same type of reflection which is clearly visible under the microscope.

Appendix – 4

Definition of Finished Leather

Buffing – An operation to produce a clean flesh surface to produce nap on leather by the action of emery wheel or a buffing machine.

Shaving – A mechanical operation of reducing the substance of leather to uniform thickness by scrapping off layers from flesh or grain side

Snuffing – The process of buffing the grain side of leather usually done by buffing machine, with visible evidence of removal of grain

Oiling – The operation of rubbing oil on the grain side of wet or sammed leather with the object of making the leather soft and pliable; in the case of vegetable tanned leather also to protect the color of tannage from darkening by oxidation.

Wax coat – Wax particulate matter should be seen under Microscope (100x) after the application of xylene on the grain surface.

NOTE 3: -Microscopic examination of wax coat:

A small drop of xylene is placed on the surface of the leather. The surface is scrapped gently using a glass rod. Leather is left for 2-3 minutes. The dried leather surface is observed under microscope for the presence of wax crystals on the surface.

Burnishable Effect – Rubbing on grain surface of leather should show a distinct gloss with a darkening of the shade giving rise to a burnishing effect. Minimum CIE ΔL value of – 3.0 on 10 dry rubbing on SATRA or any other fastness tester.

Pull up Effect – Leather shall produce a distinct pull-up effect showing a contrast light color from the base minimum CIE ΔL value of +3 as measured by the reflectance spectrophotometer.

Wool Combing- The operation through which wool entanglements are released.

Application of foil/film – Acrylic/ PVC/PU foil or film

Appendix – 4

Definition of Finished Leather

Rolling – The operation of rolling the heavy leathers like sole leather using a heavy roller with rolling machine.

3D EFFECT

Three-dimensional effect displays leather in a form that appears to be physically present with a designated structure. Essentially, it allows items that appeared flat to the human eye to be displayed in a form that allows for various dimensions to be represented.

SCALING / PERFORATED LEATHERS

Group of small holes, cuts, or deep effects or impressions or designs imparted on the leather.

EMBOSSSED LEATHER

Embossing gives a creative & decorative look to leather by stamping using heat and high pressure to create a pattern or design in the hide/skin. The pattern or design varieties range from milled grain, hair cell, alligator, crocodile, ostrich, flowers, geometric, etc.

STATE CODES

All the exporters are required to indicate the state of origin of their export product in their shipping bills. For this purpose, the following codes are to be utilized.

Code No.	Name of the State
01	ASSAM
02	MEGHALAYA
03	MIZORAM
06	BIHAR
07	JHARKHAND
09	ARUNACHAL PRADESH
10	WEST BENGAL
14	NAGALAND
15	MANIPUR

Appendix – 4

Definition of Finished Leather

16	ORISSA
17	SIKKIM
18	TRIPURA
19	ANDAMAN & NICOBAR
20	UTTAR PRADESH
21	UTTARAKHAND
29	DELHI
30	PUNJAB
34	HARYANA
39	CHANDIGARH
44	JAMMU & KASHMIR
46	HIMACHAL PRADESH
50	RAJASTHAN
54	GUJARAT
60	MAHARASHTRA
67	DAMAN & DIU
68	GOA
69	DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI
70	MADHYA PRADESH
71	CHHATTISGARH
80	ANDHRA PRADESH
84	KARNATAKA
89	LAKSHADWEEP
90	TAMIL NADU
96	KERALA
99	PUDUCHERRY
